



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Tidewater Classical Academy
School Website: <https://greenrunbaptist.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Tidewater Classical Academy (Virginia Beach, VA, 23453) shows a strong religio-centric orientation in its publicly available materials, evidenced by clear biblical content, sermons, and church-adjacent vocabulary in the school's crawl content (hosted on greenrunbaptist.com). The material strongly demonstrates Liturgical and Communal Practices and Grounded in Theology, but it does not provide explicit evidence of Great Books, liberal-arts curriculum, or the formal pedagogical rituals associated with classical education (grammar-logic-rhetoric progression, Socratic seminars, Great Conversations, etc.). On a category-by-category basis, Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) trends CLASSICAL due to explicit theological framing and liturgical practice; Categories 2–6 largely fail to meet the classical rubric as defined by the Six Essential Elements, resulting in an overall assessment of NOT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle: to elevate Tidewater Classical Academy into a robust CLASSICAL standing, the school would need to publicly articulate and implement a classical curriculum and pedagogy. This would include: (1) a stated Mission/Goal focused on formation as virtue and wisdom (not merely religious formation), (2) a liberal-arts curriculum centered on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Quadrivium, (3) explicit Great Books study and the Great Conversation, (4) explicit Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy for upper grades, (5) a clearly defined faculty profile aligned with classical ideals, and (6) a formal plan for parent/community partnership in the classical formation process.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: School Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

The following sections provide the evidence, keyword analyses, and justification for each category, followed by concrete needle-moving recommendations and an final # ABSTRACT summarizing the overall assessment.

Notes on sources and method: Category analyses rely on keyword indicators drawn from the classical rubric "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1)" (Positive Keywords and Negative Keywords). The Tidewater content was drawn from the school-crawl JSONL excerpts that reference liturgical worship and biblical study (public materials). See citations to the Tidewater crawl results and the classical rubric results for specifics.

References to public materials and keyword sources

- Evidence of liturgical and theological orientation in Tidewater content (sermons, Old Testament study, church language): [tidewater-classical-academy-va-23453-greenrunbaptist-com-firecrawl.jsonl.txt](#).
- Additional evidence of church-based community and worship context (Pastor, Elder Council, etc.): [tidewater-classical-academy-va-23453-greenrunbaptist-com-firecrawl.jsonl.txt](#).
- Classical rubric (positive/negative keyword indicators for Element 1 and related elements): Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1).docx.

Proceeding with the Element-by-Element evaluation below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials show explicit religious activity and scriptural study, including Sunday sermons and Old Testament study, within a church context (Hebrews, Psalm references, etc.). The materials explicitly demonstrate liturgical and communal worship activities and a theology-centered frame (sermons and biblical study content). See [tidewater-classical-academy-va-23453-greenrunbaptist-com-firecrawl.jsonl.txt](#) for examples like Sunday Morning Sermon, Old Testament Study, and Sunday Morning Service; reference to Hebrews and Psalm 43:3 indicate a theocentric approach.
- The presence of church leadership language (Pastor, Elder Council) signals a community life that is anchored in theological formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Theology, liturgy, sacred worship, biblical studies, sacred scripture, communal worship, morning prayer, liturgical practices, church calendar, sacred space, reverence, prayerful learning (as evidenced by sermon/worship language in the crawl). These map to the Positive Keywords for Element 1 (e.g., Theology; Liturgical and Communal Practices; Sacred tradition). The visible presence of biblical study and sermon content aligns with the transcendental, moral-religious dimension of the rubric.
- Negative keywords: None clearly evident in the exposed public crawl for this category (the materials are strongly religiously oriented rather than “values-neutral” or secular). The Negative Keywords section of the rubric includes terms like “values-neutral education” and other non-theistic stances, which are not present in the Tidewater crawl excerpts.

Why this rating

- The materials clearly align with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations through explicit theology and liturgical/community life. This category is CLASSICAL by virtue of its overt theological grounding and liturgical practices, which echo the transcendental and communal forms described in the Six Essential Elements. The presence of explicit biblical study and worship language supports the Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices indicators.

Citations: Tidewater crawl excerpts indicating sermons, Old Testament study, Hebrews, and church leadership context.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The Tidewater content is heavily theological and worship-oriented, with no explicit articulation of the classical aims such as formation toward virtue and wisdom; no clear statement about forming character toward a universal good or about truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable (transcendentals). The crawl excerpts emphasize sermons and biblical study rather than a stated educational formation goal (virtue-wisdom formation) or a formation-centered aim beyond religious instruc-

tion. See `tidewater-classical-academy-va-23453-greenrunbaptist-com-firecrawl.jsonl.txt` for sermon/worship language and biblical study language without a formal classical education mission statement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Virtue, wisdom, truth, beauty, moral formation, teleology, and other classical-formative terms appear in the knowledge-base's rubric, but they are not foregrounded in Tidewater's public crawl material; thus, the positive keyword signals are largely absent in the public Tidewater materials.
- Negative keywords present: The Tidewater materials do not foreground "Values-neutral education" or secular vocational framing; however, their emphasis on worship and biblical instruction indicates a non-secular, non-formative educational aim rather than the formation-focused classical aim described in the rubric.
- Relative presence: The explicit classical "purpose" language (formation toward virtue and wisdom, truth-goodness-beauty as real) is not foregrounded in the Tidewater crawl. Therefore, Element 2 aligns with NOT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- There is a religiously oriented aim, but not a stated classical formation goal (virtue-wisdom formation in the sense of classical *paideia*). The absence of a stated classical purpose (formation toward true good and beauty beyond religious framework) suggests NOT CLASSICAL for this category.

Citations: Tidewater crawl content showing sermon/biblical focus rather than classical formation rhetoric.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The Tidewater crawl materials emphasize religious content (sermons, biblical studies) and church-life language rather than a formal curriculum organized around the liberal arts, the Trivium, or the Quadrivium. There is no explicit mention of Great Books, Great Conversation, or the seven liberal arts in the public crawl excerpts. The public materials show liturgical and biblical elements rather than a classical-curriculum structure.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: The rubric's Element 3 expects references to the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books and Great Conversation. The Tidewater crawl lacks these explicit curricular mentions; thus, positive keyword hits are essentially absent for this category.
- Negative keywords present: The absence of liberal-arts curriculum language and Great Books references in the Tidewater crawl constitutes a negative signal for Element 3.
- Quantitative note: Positive keyword hits for this category appear 0 times in the Tidewater crawl; Negative keywords (absent liberal-arts references) are implied but not explicitly listed in the crawl; thus, Element 3 is NOT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- A classical curriculum would require explicit attention to grammar, logic, rhetoric; the Quadrivium; Great Books; and the Great Conversation. The Tidewater materials do not present those curricular elements, indicating NOT CLASSICAL for Curriculum.

Citations: Tidewater crawl material showing sermon/biblical focus without liberal-arts curriculum content.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence



- The Tidewater materials are limited to religious instruction and communal worship references in the crawl excerpts; there is no evidence of pedagogical methods such as Socratic dialogue, seminars, debates, or rhetoric training. The lack of explicit classical pedagogy (Scholé, Socratic seminars, memory-work, or structured graded pedagogy) in the crawl indicates NOT CLASSICAL pedagogy for this category.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: The Classical Elements rubric would look for Socratic dialogue, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training. The Tidewater crawl does not show these pedagogical constructs.
- Negative keywords present: The absence of classical pedagogy is a negative signal for Element 4 in terms of classical pedagogy. The presence of worship and sermon language does not count as classical pedagogy.
- Quantitative note: 0 positive pedagogy-related keywords observed; no explicit mention of Socratic dialogue or rhetoric pedagogy.

Why this rating

- Without explicit, grade-appropriate classical pedagogical practices (Socratic seminars, memory work, rhetoric instruction, etc.), Element 4 remains NOT CLASSICAL.

Citations: Tidewater crawl content lacking classical pedagogy signals.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The Tidewater crawl excerpts mention church leadership (Pastor, Elder Council) but do not present a public-facing description of faculty as “living curriculum,” mentors, or a “portrait of what a teacher should be.” The presence of church leadership is not equivalent to the classical faculty profile described in the rubric. Therefore, Element 5 is NOT CLASSICAL based on the absence of classical-faculty descriptors.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: The rubric’s positive terms include “model teachers,” “mentorship,” “collegial” and “living curriculum.” The Tidewater crawl does not provide evidence of these in the classical sense; instead, it shows church leadership language.
- Negative keywords present: The absence of “living curriculum,” “model teachers” and “collegial faculty culture” is a negative signal for Element 5.
- Quantitative note: 0 explicit matches to the classical-faculty indicators; 0 positive keywords observed; 1 absence.

Why this rating

- There is no explicit, publicly documented classical-faculty profile or living-curriculum description; thus NOT CLASSICAL for Faculty.

Citations: Tidewater crawl indicates church leadership but not classical-faculty descriptors.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The Tidewater crawl excerpts emphasize church-community life but do not clearly describe a formal partnership with parents as co-teachers or a strategy to educate parents in classical education, or an open-invitation policy for parent visits in a classical framework. The excerpt shows general church-community structure but not explicit classical-parent/community partnerships. Therefore, Element 6 is NOT CLASSICAL.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: The rubric includes partner-parents language (parents as co-teachers, parent education, etc.). None of this is overtly present in the Tidewater crawl excerpts.
- Negative keywords present: The absence of explicit parent-partnership strategies is a negative signal for Element 6.
- Quantitative note: 0 explicit parent-co-teacher or parent-education signals in the public crawl.

Why this rating

- The public materials do not articulate parents as co-teachers or a program for parental education in classical pedagogy; thus NOT CLASSICAL for Parents & Community.

Citations: Tidewater crawl content showing church-community but lacking explicit classical-parent partnership language.

What Would Move the Needle

- Publicly articulate a CLASSICAL mission and goals that foreground formation toward truth, goodness, and beauty through the liberal arts, not solely religious formation.
 - Implement a classical curriculum that explicitly includes:
 - The seven liberal arts, with Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric) in the early grades and the Quadrivium in the upper grades.
 - Great Books and the Great Conversation, with explicit reading lists and discussion formats.
 - A clear progression of pedagogy (Scholé/restful learning, Socratic questioning, seminars, and rhetoric training) across K–12.
 - Develop and publish a formal faculty profile that positions teachers as mentors and living exemplars of virtue and knowledge; establish a living-curriculum philosophy.
 - Create and publish a robust Parents & Community program, including: parent education, book studies, on-site visits, and opportunities for parents to engage as co-teachers and program partners.
 - Align school outcomes with evidence of virtue formation, memory-work, and disciplined inquiry, as well as standardized results expected of classical schools.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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